

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Immeasurable Praise of Qualities

Āryaguṇāprameyastotrādhāraṇī · Toh 680 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཡན་ཏན་བསངས་པ་དཔག་ཏུ་མཛད་པ་ཞེས་བརྟུན་གྱི་ཐུངས་

Toh 680 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as

ཕགས་པ་ཡན་ཏན་བསངས་པ་དཔག་ཏུ་མཛད་པ་ (Phags pa yon tan bsngags pa dpag tu med pa), rendered in English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī of Immeasurable Praise of Qualities." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on a sacred vidyā mantra associated with Avalokiteśvara and the buddha Amitābha, the Tathāgata of the Blissful realm (Sukhāvatī). The text presents the recitation formula along with an account of its benefits, chief among them the promise that one who recites it three hundred thousand times will behold Amitābha, and that any who read or hold the vidyā will recall their past lives across countless lifetimes and be reborn in the Pure Land. Though brief, it exemplifies the genre of practical dhāraṇī literature focused on purification, rebirth in Sukhāvatī, and devotion to bodhisattvas of compassion.

If one recites three hundred thousand times, one will come to behold the Tathāgata Amitābha. Although there are countless other benefits as well, they have been taught here in condensed form. The noble dhāraṇī called Immeasurable Praise of Qualities is complete.

Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha. Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva, the great being. Having paid homage to these, hold this vidyā. May this vidyā be accomplished in me.

Tadyathā: hana hana sāni, nava sāni, jvala jvala ne, cala cala ne, pūrvayogam nusmara phaṭ, mahāhataya svāhā.

Whoever reads this vidyā will recall their births across a hundred thousand lifetimes. And after passing away from here, they will be born in the world of the Blissful One.

The heart of the Blissful One is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The passage closes two distinct texts. The first paragraph ends the dhāraṇī called "Immeasurable Praise of Qualities." The second section beginning with the Triple Gem homage and ending with the mantra is the vidyā of Avalokiteśvara, and the final line closes a separate

short text called "The Heart of the Blissful One," likely a brief dhāraṇī associated with Amitābha or Sukhāvatī. The mantra syllables are rendered in phonetic Roman transliteration following standard convention; their Tibetan orthography is a phonetic approximation of Sanskrit. The phrase "ཀུན་གྱི་འཕགས་པའི་ཡུལ་" is literally "the world of the Blissful One," meaning the pure land of Sukhāvatī.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.